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DECLARATION OF NATHANIEL OWUSU BRENNAN

In support of Form I-130 filed on behalf of Larisa Mihaela Dumitrescu

I, Nathaniel Owusu Brennan, declare as follows:

1. My name is Nathaniel Owusu Brennan. I was born on June 14, 1991 in Toledo, Ohio, and I have been a citizen of the United States since birth. I currently live at 4172 Harlowe Bend Court, Apt. 3B, Westerville, Ohio 43081. I work as a facilities operations supervisor for a regional hospital system in Columbus, Ohio, where I have been employed since March 2018.

2. I make this declaration in support of the petition I have filed for my wife, Larisa Mihaela Dumitrescu. Everything I say here is from my own knowledge.

HOW WE MET

3. I met Larisa on October 16, 2021 at the Westerville Community Food Center. I had been volunteering there on Saturday mornings for about two years, unloading and sorting donations. Larisa joined as a volunteer that autumn. On her first morning she was assigned to the sorting table I was working at, and we spent about four hours together labelling produce boxes. I remember she was very organized about it and rearranged the whole table, which I found funny at the time and still tease her about.

4. We volunteered on the same Saturday shift most weeks through the end of 2021. In January 2022 I asked her to have dinner with me at a Vietnamese restaurant on Cleveland Avenue. That was our first date. We began seeing each other regularly after that.

OUR RELATIONSHIP BEFORE MARRIAGE

5. During 2022 we saw each other several times a week. Larisa was finishing her master's degree in health informatics, and she often studied at my apartment because it was quieter than her shared housing. In June 2022 I drove her to Cleveland to see her off on a trip to Romania to visit her parents; she was away for three weeks and we spoke every day by video call.

6. In September 2022 I introduced Larisa to my mother, Adjoa Brennan, and to my sister, Efua Brennan-Salas, at my mother's house in Toledo. We spent that Thanksgiving together with my family, and Larisa cooked a Romanian dessert called *cozonac* that my mother now asks for every year.

7. I proposed to Larisa on December 27, 2022, at the Franklin Park Conservatory, during the winter light display. She said yes. My friend Kwame Boateng was waiting nearby and photographed the moment; that photograph is included in the photographs exhibit.

OUR MARRIAGE

8. We were married on April 12, 2023 before a judge of the Franklin County Probate Court in Columbus, Ohio. It was a small ceremony. Present were my mother Adjoa Brennan, my sister Efua Brennan-Salas and her husband Rafael Salas, my friend Kwame Boateng, and Larisa's friend and former roommate Ileana Petrescu. Larisa's parents joined by video call from Sibiu, Romania because they were not able to travel. Afterwards we had lunch for the group at a restaurant in the Short North.

9. We did not have a large wedding because we were both saving money, and because Larisa's family could not travel. We plan to hold a religious ceremony in Romania once her immigration status permits her to travel and return.

OUR LIFE TOGETHER

10. Larisa and I have lived together since our marriage. From April 2023 through July 2024 we lived at 219 Wexford Mill Lane, Apt. 5C, Westerville, Ohio 43081. That was the apartment I had rented since 2020, and the lease was in my name alone. When our lease came up for renewal in mid-2024 we decided we needed more space, and on July 18, 2024 we signed a new lease together for our current apartment at 4172 Harlowe Bend Court, Apt. 3B, Westerville, Ohio 43081. Both of our names are on that lease and on the utility account.

11. We opened a joint checking account at Beacon Ridge Credit Union on June 2, 2023. My paycheck is deposited into that account and we pay our rent, utilities, groceries, and car payment from it. We filed our 2023 federal income tax return jointly as a married couple in March 2024.

12. In July 2023 I named Larisa as the sole beneficiary of my employer-provided life insurance policy. In October 2023 we combined our automobile insurance into a single policy listing both of us as drivers.

13. Our daily life is ordinary. I leave for work at 6:00 a.m. and Larisa makes coffee for both of us the night before. She handles our budget spreadsheet because she is better at it than I am. We cook most evenings, we go to my mother's house in Toledo about once a month, and on Saturdays we still volunteer at the food center where we met.

14. I married Larisa because I love her and I intend to spend my life with her. Our marriage is genuine and was not entered into for any immigration purpose.

I declare under penalty of perjury under the laws of the United States of America that the foregoing is true and correct.

Executed on August 29, 2024, at Westerville, Ohio.

/s/ Nathaniel O. Brennan
Nathaniel Owusu Brennan
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Westerville, OH 43081